MACHINE TRANSCRIPT · CORAGGIO CONSULTING

Virginia Board of Education, Work Session, Wednesday, September 14, 2022

Date	Wednesday, September 14, 2022
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	2h 57m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XLY0vCLSzmg
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

> Machine transcript (speech-to-text) produced by Coraggio Consulting. Not an official county record. Names and numbers may be misspelled; check the video at the timestamp before quoting.

Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:01:16] Creasy? Yes. Good. Good vote. Yes. Ms. Halton? Yes. Dr. Sievert? Hi. Dr. Mann? Yes. Mr. Rothen? Yes. Ms. Dutta? Yes. Mr. Hanson? Yes. Chair votes aye. Okay. So we are back in public session. Chair will entertain a motion to deny a license to Amber Dawn Wears. Is there such a motion? So moved. Thank you. Ms. Creasy. Is there a second? Second. Thank you, Dr. Mann. Ms. Creasy? Now we're voting. Yes. Okay. Vote by roll call. Ms. Halton? Yes.

[00:01:47] Yes. Dr. Siebert? Yes. Dr. Mann? Aye, yes. Mr. Rotherham? Aye, yes. Ms. Dutta? Yes. And Mr. Hanson? Yes. Chair votes? Yes. On case two, I'll take a motion to defer with a request that staff request that the applicant be present, or at least understand that the board has questions it would like answered and given the opportunity to be present at our next meeting.

[00:02:15] Is there a motion to defer? So moved. Thank you. Is there a second? Second. Thank you. Again, by roll call, Ms. Creasy. Aye. Ms. Holton. Aye. Dr. Siebert. Aye. Dr. Mann. Aye. Mr. Rotherham.

[00:02:31] Aye. Ms. Dutta. Aye. Mr. Hanson. Aye. Okay, I'll entertain a motion to issue a license in case number three. Is there a motion? So moved. Thank you. Ms. Holton. Is there a second? Second. Thank you, Dr. Mann. Ms. Creasy.

[00:02:46] Aye. Ms. Holton. Aye. Mr. Rotham nay. Sorry, the motion is to... Is to issue the license in case three. Aye. Mr. Hanson? No. Because I'm voting no.

[00:03:06] I thought we had that carried and closed, but maybe not. Oh, I guess it was. Okay, well, that does not carry at this point.

[00:03:25] So we're going to move on to the last one. We'll ask the AG, does that license just not get issued? All right, entertain a motion. Council, Mr. President, do you want to roll calls again just because we thought our count what's different and it may be we just got confused well no i know where the difference is oh okay so if you're satisfied there's no confusion i see no need no there's no confusion i mean and i certainly don't you're not critical of anybody changing their voting different from the private kind of question so we'll have to figure that one out let's move on to uh the last

[00:04:04] case and we are going to entertain a motion to revoke the license of michael david tucci so move thank you dr siebert thank you miss creasy uh miss creasy hi miss holton hi dr siebert hi dr mann hi mr rotherham hi uh miss dada no uh mr hanson and chair votes aye all right uh our ag

[00:04:35] advisors yes um i would have to research that that question because we've never had a we usually have the majority is at the given majority and this one you have someone to abstain from the vote no we don't have anybody abstaining yeah and so i don't want to go into a lot of people no that's all right but i'll defer and get an answer for you and what you may do on the record is um defer that to give an answer from our office well there's got to be a statute of

[00:05:12] limitations problem with that right or a statute of frauds problem because it may not come within my lifetime that's all good uh yeah please we're gonna you know we will be in public session again tomorrow so that maybe we can get this resolved overnight to your i think that's right but i want

[00:05:46] to be sure on a licensure issue i mean i i mean my gut says but i don't want to give good opinions on this i just want to be sure i think that's right but uh i don't know if there's a specific issue with regard to license cases and property rights and all the other things that go with this all right uh that covers believe it or not the morning session which was supposed to be done at new great job guys yeah is there a motion to adjourn to the dinner yeah can we move to dinner

[00:06:24] all right i want to take five minutes and then we will be back in session for the afternoon agenda

[00:06:29] thank you sir yeah i think you're right grace but it's too important uh welcome everybody i had

[00:18:53] two and a half hours of opening comments prepared. However, given the hour that we're starting as compared to when we thought we'd start this, I will not give any of that two and a half hour brilliant address. And we will begin right away with the update on the process to review and revise the history and social science standards of learning. Kristania, or Ms. Brown, excuse me.

[00:19:17] Good afternoon. Hello. And I did note that the slide deck this time was not a hundred pages. - It is not. - I am duly thankful. - It is not.

[00:19:33] You're all good? All right, well, thank you very much, President Gecker, Vice President Mann, members of the board, Superintendent Baylow. We come before you today to provide an update of the timeline for the review and revision of the History and Social Science Standards of Learning.

[00:19:52] And probably can do this in about 12 slides. So we're going to talk about two specific points today, updating the timeline and then the proposed decoupling of the standards document. I love that word.

[00:20:07] We're going to use it all the time, decoupling, decoupling the document. So the proposed update gives us an opportunity to do a few things. What we've done is outlined it in by month between now and a proposed anticipated final review in January.

[00:20:29] So right now staff is, we are working currently with creating a standards document separate from what we have traditionally known as our curriculum frameworks document for each course.

[00:20:44] And we want to make sure those documents are concise, clean, understandable, and accessible for all. Public comment, we opened public comment July 25th, and it will remain open on September 25th.

[00:21:02] And I'll talk a little bit more about that in just a moment. And also we are currently working closely with department senior leadership to review all of those documents, standards documents, and what we will see as our curriculum frameworks.

[00:21:19] From there, much of the same from September still, working to make sure that the document is concise, clean, understandable, working with our expert, national expert to decouple them, make sure that we are looking at the public comments, again, 'cause public comments will close on September 25th.

[00:21:46] But what's different from between September and October, that's when we plan to have three of the community engagement session. those will take place, the first three will take place and be conducted in person in October.

[00:22:02] That process we will communicate through superintendent's memos. We will also utilize our community, excuse me, parent engagement, executive director, and then other means or streams of communication so that everyone is aware of how to register the expectations of that session and what we will be doing in that session what will happen to the information from that session so those first three will take place in october the determining schedule is mostly based on the locations and their availability

[00:22:41] we have been in contact with 10 to 12 different locations across the commonwealth so we just need enough time to go back to them and say okay are you available in in this month this time or this date so that we can go ahead and schedule those our expectation is that we should be able to have a schedule by late next week so that we can start communicating that because october is not that far away so we do need to give ample time for communication and registration from there we We are looking to bring the documents,

[00:23:19] both documents to you in November for first review. And we also would like to host two community engagement sessions in person in November. As you know, November, we have a lot of holidays during that time.

[00:23:37] So we will try our best to make sure that we schedule two in-person sessions during November. continuing the process that we will be using for those community engagement sessions, but most importantly, to get the documents ready for you for first review in November.

[00:23:57] And again, we're looking at a standards document and separate curriculum framework documents for each course. From there, in December, our goal is for your public hearings to occur the first week, first full week of December, December 5th through the 9th.

[00:24:21] And we have some locations already picked out for that just to make sure that they are able to host us. So we will be in communication with Emily so that we can get that scheduled to you. Again, we just need to confirm that various locations will be able to host us.

[00:24:41] and also in working with Emily to make sure that it works with your schedule. Also in December, because we have gone through, hopefully anticipated you have accepted the documents for first review in November, we will be reconciling information from public comments and then also from those public, excuse me, community engagement sessions.

[00:25:09] So our goal as far as community engagement sessions, we hope to conduct a virtual session during the month of December. Last thing that we'd like to do in December is to take our document to our historian steering committee.

[00:25:28] I mentioned last month that we did have a steering committee of historians and college professors, about six, and we'd like to take the documents back to them their final look to ensure that we have historical accuracy in the content in our standards and the curriculum frameworks and then that brings us to january 2023 with the goal of bringing to you for final review the standards and the curriculum frameworks for each of the courses um working with

[00:26:04] leadership to make sure that it is as our superintendent says um prime time ready or ready for prime so um that is our goal updating the schedule the timeline it does not put us far behind our original timeline that we brought to the board in january of 2021 so we're looking at no more than um a month's delay and which is it which isn't bad i don't think it puts us in a

[00:26:38] bad position as far as the delay is concerned but it does give us an opportunity to review the document for um conciseness to make sure that we have everything that we need there and i do want to make sure um to let you know that we need to make sure that we consider all of the public comments and the information or feedback that we're getting from the community engagement sessions so what does this the decoupling look like we had we brought to you in august one document and that

[00:27:13] one document was basically 13 courses in all of the standards and everything about each of those courses in one document and we did get feedback that for some people it was very overwhelming or hard to read or hard to separate which is fine so in taking in that feedback you may remember from the 2015 standards document this is what the standards look like you have the introduction of the course you have the skills and then you have just the standard so we are working right now to

[00:27:47] pull those apart and you will have a just the standards document and then the second document which looks a little different but the format of the curriculum framework those other areas that you've found or that you saw in the standards document that we presented to you in august is put in more of a chart form turned to the side and easily read to where you have that column for understanding you have the column for supporting questions and then you have the column for the knowledge and learning experiences so it's separated but it's still the same content that

[00:28:26] was in that one document that we brought to you in august so in closing just as a summary we will close public comment in september september 25th and it does not mean that community members parents organizations cannot provide public comment to us we take public comment 365 days a year 24 hours a day so we will still be able to take those public comments but this in order for us to process what we have we do need to cut off that public comment period and

[00:29:04] then get ready for our community engagement sessions um and they are very welcome to submit comments during that session also next um again conducting the community roundtable sessions between october and november to be able to gather all of that information and then present for first review a standards document curriculum frameworks in november that's what we are anticipating have our public hearings in december and then that information along with everything else that we've

[00:29:42] collected thus far to anticipate final approval at the january board meeting so at this time if you have any questions i will gladly answer them but i hope that that gives you enough of an update that we can move forward christiania we appreciate it greatly and thank you all for being here with us we know how much attention this work has gotten uh and frankly how much information has been passed around the public a lot of it not correct about what's going on in terms of the the process and the content of the standards, like the status.

[00:30:18] To the best of my knowledge, I think the team would confirm that as of today, the comments that we are changing or not teaching all history are just not factually correct. The process we've been involved with now has been strictly related to what the document looks like, the form of the document, and as I think you mentioned, there was a sense that the document was unwieldy in its current form.

[00:30:41] And I will also say, in fairness to the team, we understand that that form was sort of a directive of, you know, the department when this work started. And you know, I'm not saying it was a bad idea because I don't think it was a bad idea, but I do think that when we tried to execute that idea, the board became and staff became aware of and the superintendent became aware of, you know, certain things that we thought we could do better and more plainly explained not only to the public but to the teachers who are going to have to use this document. And so I know you've learned a new word, decouple,

[00:31:16] that you now love dearly. But, you know, from my perspective, you know, the goal has always been to provide a document that, as you know, everybody in the administration has said, fully and fairly teaches history, the good and the bad, in a way that people understand it. And I, you know, I will say, because this does come up with so many people that, in In my opinion, at this point, the claims that there have been substantive changes to the document to reflect what people's view of current views are is just categorically incorrect.

[00:31:50] So with that having been said, are there any comments or questions from board members? Yeah, Dr. Mann. Thank you so much for that overview. I'm curious on the community engagement sessions, because they're going to be a limited number.

[00:32:06] How are you making decisions about where they're going to be held, and can you -- what are you anticipating in terms of the invitation or how many people are you trying to imagining you know you might need to have space for i'm i'm just curious about that part of it we're looking at cutting registration off at 100 because to be able to maneuver that large of a group knowing that is our greatest number we're looking at spaces that will be able to hold that many people

[00:32:45] part of the registration will be well we're going to be asking people to not only choose a specific location but also a specific level and or course that will help us to prepare for the people coming to the session and if we need to reach out to any of our division-wide specialists or coordinators to help us facilitate those small group sessions also prior to or a part

[00:33:21] of the registration once they have registered we'll provide them with information it's not our goal to necessarily go through the process like like we did at our august meeting but a pre-video for them to watch and then also some questions that they can bring to the session having answers so that we can use that time wisely once they get there so and i'm not saying that this is the question but for example um what changes would you recommend to a specific course and that way

[00:34:00] if they have that already with them when they are working in those small groups then we're not fumbling through trying to figure out the answers to those questions they're bringing work to the session and it's more so a work session rather than a feedback or input session um so our first goal is to ensure that we have between the community engagement sessions and the public hearings to cover the state and because of weather and everything else we usually whenever we try to

[00:34:36] do that we usually try to start in the far southwest and move east um but still holding to that we do have some locations that will be able to hold us if we go up to 100 to make accommodations for that the second is um for a lot of places that we've tried parking you don't want you want to try to lessen as many barriers from keeping people from coming so we want to make sure that it's not some type of fiscal barrier for parents and community members to come but also accessible for

[00:35:16] them to come thinking about something that may seem right off of 95 but if it's right off of 95 towards Fredericksburg at a certain time that might be a barrier so we have to keep all of that in mind but first and foremost making sure we cover the state limiting so that we can use the time effectively to 100 participants and giving them something specific that they will be doing prior to coming to the meetings and then while we're there other questions thank you miss brown and team i know you all have been hard at work on this and are going to continue to be hard at work

[00:35:55] on it all fall. I'm very grateful. With respect to the process, is there a place, I know there's very active interest in all of this in the public, and we're grateful for that. Is there a way that people can sign up now somewhere to ask to be notified when the community engagement sessions or registration opens? Or who are you going to send the, you're going to send it to the superintendent's memo, but I don't know whether, can everybody sign up for the superintendent's memo list well the memos are posted um on the doe website but we also have

[00:36:29] our parent engagement um executive director that i'm hoping that they have um access to other parental groups or community groups we also have the um communication of the principal's email which is more closely related to parents than maybe the superintendent of a division so sending the information directly to principals at that level to please communicate this to your parents in your school and then also one of our external committees was the virginia pta so

[00:37:08] hopefully between that social media platforms that we also have we will be able to communicate it right now there is not a way to say can you alert me unless there's something that i'm not aware of but as far as our program is concerned i don't really have something that will send out an alert well maybe the social media is the answer but i've just heard from an awful lot of people who are eager to participate which is great but they may not be people who are on the superintendent's memo mailing list so if will it be posted immediately on social media once the registration

[00:37:47] site goes live yeah so if people want to watch for that and be ready to register then they should be following virginia doe news on their social media yeah and count on that great um next question also a process question i appreciate the concept of these as a work session i appreciate that you're going to give

them homework are you anticipating having an updated draft for them to react to or are you going to be asking them to react to the august draft or june draft or whatever it is or what what are you asking them to react to my goal is for them to have the individual

[00:38:25] curriculum frameworks in the standards document so that you're not getting the 346 page if you sign up and say that you want to um participate in the community engagement sessions and specifically talk about kindergarten then you will only have kindergarten um standards and framework to look at so hopefully by this first one but you're expecting to have the kindergarten and you're expecting to have the k-12 standards and framework ready uh for the community engagement

[00:39:02] sessions so will they be can we ask that they be because some folks may not know which ones they want to react to until they get to see can that draft be posted somewhere when available that i'm not sure of if that can be posted the content um no matter what is the same what we have posted for the board docs from august that's what we've decoupled there's no extra content that has been added or changed around we've just split the document into those

[00:39:39] two that i've shown you so your anticipation is the draft that you're going to be working from i mean you've obviously had an opportunity to correct some typos right but uh but other than that you're anticipating that the draft that will be being shared for public response is basically the same as the draft that was presented to the board yes so you're not anticipating major reductions or additions to that content before the community engagement no me okay no but now the draft that you will present to us for consideration for the board at first review will

[00:40:15] it still be the same content or will it reflect updates based on some of the sessions to date it will we will try to make sure that it reflects the updates up to that point because we do have we are looking at scheduling two community engagement meetings in november now the november board meeting especially due to holidays i believe is early like the 17th or 18th so if we are able to do a community engagement meeting maybe that first week of november then we can consider what's

[00:40:51] coming from there um we don't we won't have any community engagement sessions my mistake we will have a virtual session in december that will need to go forth with what we are proposing for january well and and i assume what will go forward to the public hearings for december will be the draft that we accept on first review yes and the draft that we accept on first review will be decoupled yes but it may also have content changes additions or subtractions based on the department's

[00:41:30] evaluation of the uh public comment various comment you got up to that stage through all the various sources yes up until that point and again the meeting being the 17th or 18th of november what we can prepare because we also need to give it to you right and if the meeting is the 17th we're looking at the end of october for us to consider what we've pulled in from the community engagement sessions and also right now we're looking at public comments as they're coming in

[00:42:09] but we need to cut that off so that we can kind of process and see what types of input we may need to pull from public comment that's going to impact the content but it will not be let me backtrack it will be we'll look at public comment and what we can from the community engagement sessions up to that point the process for that document so the first review document will incorporate as much as you can of all of that recognizing you need to give us a little time to read it and recognizing that that probably needs realizing how much work you all have in front of

[00:42:46] you but that will be more than a week in other words to read the what is still going to be close to 400 pages of content between the two well between the two yes because it won't be in one document it will be in 14 right separate but but um but then if the content's not fundamentally at least you're not anticipating fundamental changes in the content then we're still talking about a lot of content to review and having spent quite a bit of time this summer reading the 400 page version. And I'm not sure that you're going to be able to redline this in a way.

[00:43:25] Maybe there's a way you can redline it, too. That would be extremely helpful if you could figure out, despite the decoupling, if you could figure out a way to highlight for us in the version we're looking at for November what's changed from the June version to July version, that would be extremely helpful, just because of the timing of our review.

[00:43:51] And then again, in our January, the document you present to us for consideration on final review in January, obviously, will have incorporated the ensuing community engagement session feedback.

[00:44:07] Yes. And whatever we hear from public comment in December, and some of us will be at some of those public comment hearings, but we won't all be at all of them. assume you all prepare some kind of a summary document for us yes of our community engagement sessions and the public comment the public hearings when we present the document for first review in November we'll provide for you a summary of what we've gone through thus far and that is not only the public comments but also a summary of the community engagement sessions and you'll update that in January in January great yes so if you can figure out how to as I

[00:44:44] say, not highlight every time you've moved. I mean, as I understand it, if it's in the standards or in the curriculum framework, the teachers and the students are equally responsible for the content, whether it's in one document or the other. Is that correct? Yes, that is correct. So the decoupling really shouldn't change fundamentally. Something having moved from one document to the other shouldn't fundamentally change the implications.

[00:45:09] So to the extent you can figure out, obviously it doesn't help us if you highlight everything that's moved from one place to the other but if changes other than that if you can if you can figure out how to highlight or flag for us changes that affect content not just the order in some fashion that'll really help us for those of us who've had a chance to look at the first draft and for the public's sake as well well and miss creasy um mentioned it last time and we kind of thought about the um the crosswalk maybe not an official crosswalk but just a separate chart that

[00:45:46] says vs.2 um b is a new is new and or it's moved something here or this is the the change in the language for world geography 7. that way you'll have that chart and you can follow it and it gets It's complicated when we start putting colors and highlights and double underlines and strikethroughs.

[00:46:14] The document becomes difficult to read, so it may be easier to put that on a chart that shows where and what has changed. And I'm not asking every time you've corrected the spelling of a word, but anything that would have content implications, if you could put that in some kind of a chart for us, I think that would be really helpful.

[00:46:37] I recognize that's one more ask for an otherwise very busy team, so, but I'm also hearing you say that so far you haven't made, based on the public comment you've gotten so far and what you've done,

you haven't made, well, let me ask it this way, have you made any cuts to the content from the document?

[00:46:57] Thus far, we have not really made any changes to the document from what was posted, just trying to make sure that we get all of our public comments schedule these community engagement sessions we've not made any I'm sorry I thought I had understood earlier that you have a working draft where you've done things like fix some of the typos well yes this is also we've done that but as far as changing content based on input we have it we've gathered it but we've not made

[00:47:29] it yet to the document yeah based on that gathering are you anticipating based on what you know so far any major well any any real cuts to the content that was in the document i don't anticipate any major changes or deletions of content um what we have tried what we've seen with the public comments and also from working with our committees whether it was our educators committee or external

[00:48:06] it was more of expanding and being more inclusive of other people's events cultures so i don't anticipate any type of deletions especially major deletions in content that And obviously that depends on what you hear from the public, et cetera, but that's where you are now.

[00:48:30] Okay. That's very helpful to understand. Thank you. You're so welcome. Other questions? So thank you. Thank you, Ms. Brown, for the presentation, and thanks to you all for being here. And I do appreciate this really very deliberative process that's taken many months now, and it's probably going to take a few more months.

[00:48:54] Yes. And I appreciate your question, Ms. Holton, about how we're going to be able to see it in the coming weeks, how we're going to be able to go in, because as of now, I'm still going into that one version that's available to me, and you mentioned the content's not changing, and I'll just keep my comments briefer than usual.

[00:49:22] I just have a couple of things to say, though. I mean, multiple people, you know, what I've seen so far is it's just very jargon-heavy, kind of difficult to understand, test academic concepts. And so, you know, it's just making the SELs more subjective and less specific.

[00:49:44] And I know, I think what I infer from what you're saying, some of the things that there are a lot of instances where material is being moved to a different section, but when you go to that section, it's not there. There are a few instances that I have, and just making it bulky, like the profile of a Virginia graduate is there.

[00:50:03] It just makes it very hard to navigate. One major point that I have is that the SOLs are advocating for what's called inquiry learning, and it's known by many names, like discovery learning, problem-based learning, inquiry learning, experimental learning, constructivist learning, learning by experiences.

[00:50:28] and the processes you know it is appealing to some but empirical research has shown that you know overwhelming and unambiguous evidence that minimal guidance during instruction is significantly less effective and efficient and guidance specifically designed to support the cognitive processing I'm sorry and in it's just based on the language that's actually used and so i mean all i'm saying is that only when learners have a like a solid base that can

[00:51:03] they learn from experience-based pedagogy and to introduce something called an inquiry learning at this time of you know pandemic catastrophic law i think it's backward in my view um and so

that's one point i had did you want to yeah i did have a question and i apologize for um speaking over you the research that you or the what you just quoted do you have that search could you could you give

[00:51:35] that to me please because i'll send you the papers okay and um just to reiterate the the move or the shift or mind shift to go into inquiry based um practices is not something that just came out of this team but we did research with not only the national council of the social studies but we also made reference and read through the educating for an american democracy which also advocates

[00:52:11] looking at inquiry-based practices for history and social science and something it goes by different names and some of which you have mentioned but also thinking about um the inquiry based or discovery or i believe in science they call it the five e's explore exploration so it would be very beneficial for us to to look at the research that you're speaking of because

[00:52:40] i've not yet read any research contour contour contour to um using inquiry-based practices for history and social science and it is something that for the past i know for um virginia especially moving or looking at balanced assessment plans and legislation that was passed in 2014 with the use of local alternative assessments we really dealt into

[00:53:13] this whole idea of helping students use primary and secondary source documents not just textbooks so really looking at how inquiry-based based practices not only support the content knowledge for history and social science but also reading and writing for history and social science and also building those skills so i'd be very interested to read the research that you're speaking of thank you appreciate that you mentioned um the national council for social studies yes

[00:53:48] ma'am okay it's i did did look like look that up and a couple of things um there's a lot of stuff on their website that's disturbing to me some of it's it talks about the narrative um told through the lens of those who created and continue to benefit from america country american cultural institutions says white financially secure christian heterosexual cisgender males that's one of the views that they've stated on their website and okay i could quote a few others

[00:54:25] which i think is pretty divisive and controversial to say the least um you know it it says that the school districts are the most active battlefield in the american culture wars they um you can read more but to one last point uh i'll just make so that's that's disturbing to me um but the themes and concepts it's pretty cluttered through in a very repetitive manner and i think that would be probably part of what you're going to be streamlining when you decouple probably the the fact

[00:55:04] that a lot of these things themes and concepts are cluttered um but what is a very a little disconcerting to me is that these themes and concepts talk about um questionable concepts like conflict and power relationships and highlighting colonialism imperialism servitude enslavement nationalism racism cultural expressionism over like basic economic principles and they define freedom in terms of power, you know, the power to act without hindrance or restraint through

[00:55:42] agency and advocacy, rather than just in terms of the traditional American values of individual liberty and economic freedom, you know, subject to due process under law. So when I see these words, it's, and then I look back at the NCSS website, it just thinks a lot of things are very disturbing you know another proposed change to replace good citizens with responsible citizenship across several grades um some would question this as a bias against making judgments or teaching kids

[00:56:16] what's right and what's wrong so that's um i will i'm sorry your last your last comment of teaching why you know so why wouldn't you teach a student like you know it's a bias against making judgments or to teach kids what is right what is wrong what's good citizenship there is something called a good citizenship to to delete that um just to me personally i just don't think it's right okay well um we also had a form for our board members and if you would like to um

[00:56:57] we can speak one-on-one so that i can get a better understanding because yes i did also request i could make the meeting and i apologize for the last minute cancellation so i would love to have the opportunity okay that would be that would be wonderful we can set that meeting up so that i can get a better understanding of um what you're speaking of as divisive thank you mr hanson did you have a question for me i did and um just in terms of the community engagement uh outreach

[00:57:31] two meetings with 100 people just just intuitively seems um very minimalist to me and i just would encourage you to have contingency planning or thoughts whether it's 200 or 250 or um but also just like to understand too is this first come first serve or are you going to be determining who gets to participate or how is that going to work our goal is and again to ensure that we are effectively using that time that's the main reason for um the the number cut off and it's not to

[00:58:10] eliminate anyone and yes you have the link there will be other locations and we do have that option of the virtual community engagement session but we want to make sure that we can best use that time and 100 people to have as a work session it's probably a lot but i think that's something that we can handle um to make sure that we get the best out of the people who who come um so with the sessions that we are trying to schedule right now in october and

[00:58:48] November and then that virtual session for people who did not or were not able to come to any of the sessions that we had scheduled so yes first come first serve but different locations across the commonwealth and what is going to be the reference point for soliciting input is it going to be more of a micro edits for different standards for different grades or are you going going to be open to type of comments that Superna just had about you know the whole issue of the

[00:59:24] structural and the conceptual design of this versus just taking what's out there and you know going through you know checking the boxes are you going to be open to more broad conversations and debates about what Superna just said? I think we we do need to be open to all of those different types of comments especially if we're talking about a structural um change but people will whether they come to the community engagement sessions or not um or excuse me people who come to those

[01:00:02] community engagement sessions if they do have specifics they will be able to submit those individually but what we'd really like for them to do is to work in those small groups and come to a consensus about any types of changes that they would like to make now whether that is specific to a standard specific to a learning experience or specific to what mrs duda was bringing up about the themes or um the the fact that we have the profile of a virginia graduate in this document they will come to a consensus as a smaller group about that and we'll be able to

[01:00:41] collect it but if there is something specific that a person in a group wants to provide to us as far as comments are concerned they'll have that opportunity to do that also we don't like to shy away from anyone's comments input or work towards this document accepting all comments now we have to consider um the comments as far as their accuracy or is this going to work for this document overall but in the end it is something that you as a board will make a final decision about when it

[01:01:17] comes to structure and content hope that answers your question it does okay um also just in terms of getting this through january 2023 can you also and i think asked the last meeting too but just really trying to better understand where do we go from january 23 to implementation with the sols that come summer and fall, and maybe just a quick understanding of that.

[01:01:43] There are a lot of things that are involved with that, and as I stated in August, there are some decisions that the board will need to make when it comes to textbooks. There are some decisions that will need to be made as far as our professional development, once we are approved anticipating for january we will then start with first developing the official crosswalk from 2015 to the 2022 or 2023 whatever it is and then the next step would be to start

[01:02:22] putting together resources and pd that we hopefully will be able to start implementing in summer of 2023 because school divisions will need to start working on their crossover to from the 2015 to the new standards and begin to think about what pd they will need specifically in their school divisions and resources that they will need specifically also and they'll need to rewrite

[01:02:56] their local developed curriculum based on the standard i just do want to go on record um you know after our last meeting i think was two days after our sol numbers came out and for the history and social studies pre-pandemic we are at 80 pass rate went down to 54 or 66 now and i just am very concerned that we are engaging in a process about process that where we need to be focused like we've

[01:03:31] never been focused before about closing that gap and injecting this uncertainty injecting this change for change sake and again i'm still not even sure what the elevator speech is of what three things we're trying to fix here from the 2015 standards and so i for one just feel like we're engaging in a process that is disruptive when we need to be doubling down on getting our kids back to where they were much less getting that 80 percent number we should have been trying

[01:04:06] to get that to 90 percent in a pandemic mindset and so i feel like we are creating a whole bunch of dust up and work and even in our current situation with teacher shortages and trying to to then put this on top of what they maybe have been trained to do for the last five or ten years. I just think that we're really embarking on a process that I think is not most helpful to students, not most helpful to teachers, not most helpful to parents, not most helpful to the Commonwealth. And so I just really want to make for certain

[01:04:44] and I just want to really understand better the process and the demands that we're going be putting on teachers in the system in the coming months as to me this isn't worth it we've got just really a once-in-a-century crisis going on right now in the learning loss and the achievement gaps between our different student groups are more distant than they've ever been as well and we need to be focused on how do we close those achievement gaps how do we close the learning gap versus again just getting a lot of wheels in motion over process when there's

[01:05:21] nothing wrong I don't believe what the current standards or if there's some minor adjustments we need to make but not to just totally disrupt the apple cart for the sake of disrupting the apple cart to help us get where we need to be I appreciate your comments any others you know I had to do it so I so appreciate all the work that you all have put in you know, as you've gathered comments from us and really internalized those comments, you know, of course, I noted to you all last time that and then in our one-on-one meeting that

[01:06:00] I feel like it's really important from a classroom teacher perspective, we know already that classroom teachers are anticipating new standards. And with those new standards that they're anticipating, they already have an astronomical economical amount of stress around what we are going to deliver to them as far as increased demands on both content and process. But I really do believe that stepping back in this structure and separating the document in this particular way is going to really help to

[01:06:36] alleviate a lot of that stress. I do think that Mr. Hansen's comments are well suited for this particular issue, because I'm going to bring it up again, and that is I feel strongly that we need to see what the content-based difference is between the 2015 standards and these standards, because I think that that kind of alleviates a lot of stress overall, right? So if teachers are in the classroom thinking, oh my gosh, they're going to just load me down with more

[01:07:10] content that I'm going to have to teach than I already am in my 180 days. Well, let's help them calm those nerves. Let's show them that just because this document looks differently right now does not mean we're asking you to add 10 more days worth of content on your back. So I think, I really do think there is just so much credence to having a document that shows what's the difference here. What's the difference in, you know, my civics and economics standards today that I'm teaching than what I'm being asked in these new

[01:07:48] standards to do? Thank you. Thank you, though. Yes, I was wanting to hear Ms. Creasey's, she's the history person as far as I'm concerned from my science teacher perspective. A couple things. One, thank you, thank you, thank you. Even the hundred slides last month and that presentation i think that helped send help give a good sense to the general public throughout the commonwealth of the process that's been underway and it has been a long thoughtful intentional deliberate process so i thank you for that i think that was very helpful i think that the

[01:08:25] emphasis on engagement here is is is key and and again i think yes they're that you're gonna have these sessions that um some capacity limitations but really helping you keep maintain the word for all of us to help maintain the word everybody approaches us public comment is available now and it remains available through the end of september so we need to keep keep that message out i do commend you and thank you taking on this this pause plus this formatting change and creating this abundant engagement and so that's a whole lot of work and it's a work on you all but i think there's also a burden coming on us as a board in terms of the time constraint because ultimately

[01:09:02] whereas if i'm a u.s virginia history teacher when i get those standards that's that's what i that I need to focus on 'cause that's what I teach. But we have an obligation to our teachers to make sure that we do keep this process moving and that we do get to a finish point. Because if I'm a kindergarten, third grade, fifth grade, sixth grade teacher, I'm teaching multiple content areas.

[01:09:22] I can't just focus on U.S. Virginia history. I can't just focus on world geography. I have to focus on all these content areas. And we are beginning in the Commonwealth to kick off the math standards. And so we owe it to our teachers to not bring multiple years of standards to bear at one time. so i appreciate the efforts going on i especially like the chart you've created because i think it gets some of the concerns that was lifted up before i think when you have a column focused on the knowledge and and learning experiences i think that's very very helpful because again some of the you know concerns out there have been that i mean but it's not really concerns we know you cannot critically think about something you cannot apply something until you know something so you

[01:10:00] must know things to be able to do things and so i i think that chart will be helpful in in that regard so i i appreciate i appreciate that but i do think um we're going to i sense a challenge coming where ultimately you know perfection does become the enemy of progress and and and maybe that's why you'll be thoughtful about how much you do and how where you do it and how you communicate where the differences really are because ultimately we've got to get this to a very solid place and done for the sake of the teachers who will who will need to implement it

[01:10:35] and then many of them turn their attention to math in short order thank you any other questions yeah so did you mention the director the parent engagement executive director he would be we will engage with him so just in case there are um groups parental groups that i'm not aware of to uh alert them that we will be having these community engagement sessions and to pass along the registration information necessary is that tom wilson yes ma'am tom wilson

[01:11:21] uh i don't have a lot to add to the conversation uh thank you uh i think the way we're going does make a lot of sense i would just urge us you know we've got these national groups we also have just great people here in virginia so like i you know so that is question about sort of how do you balance content with inquiry like dan willingham over at uva is a psychologist i mean he's like a national leader on this and he goes all over the country he's right in our backyard we should think about like engaging him on the evidence base of how do you you do need knowledge like um like dr seba was just saying and then how do you do inquiry with that the core knowledge foundation is also

[01:11:56] coincidentally over in charlottesville um and you know has a terrific curriculum uh and sort of an idea of how do you get in balance sort of really rich content knowledge with then teaching kids to think in critical and engaging ways about that content so i would just urge us i know we've had a long long process there's been a lot of input a lot of committees but i feel like there's folks just right here in the commonwealth who ness we haven't necessarily knocked on their door and it might they might have like a lot of uh advice and so forth to help us get this uh get this balance where we want it thank you anything else mr gecker i think we're pretty much okay i would like to

[01:12:34] just remind the board members that our job at this point is not to sort of make individual editing changes to the document i mean that still is within the purview of the staff and is ably led by the superintendent of public instruction. We do manage the process because the obligation to produce new standards of learning, or at least reviewed standards of learning every seven years, is put by the General Assembly on us.

[01:12:58] And although it may seem like an inappropriate time to be engaging in an overhaul of the standards, I mean, in fairness, we started this in, I guess, 2020 as part of the statutory mandate to review and revise every seven years, or no later than every seven years.

[01:13:14] And so we're a long way into this process. It's not like we're beginning anew. When the standards come before the board in their first form, to the extent the board wants to then do sort of line by line changes, we will do it line by line.

[01:13:30] If there are things in the standards that the staff presents that people disagree with or don't want, we will take votes on every item to either keep them or delete them. If there are things that aren't there that people want, we will take votes on every item to keep or delete to add or not add. I mean, that's sort of our role in this, and it's very difficult, you know, not to want to sort of tinker with the drafting now from our level because it's going to come to us.

[01:13:57] But the point of the public process is to allow the department to finish their work. You know, I'm really hopeful that we can all allow the department to finish its work. If we're going to maintain a time schedule like this, which by the way still gets us later than the statutory deadline, but if we're going to maintain a time schedule like this, we need to have some faith that staff will do an adequate and appropriate first draft, bring it back to the board, and at that point, if you all want to pick it apart and talk about every line, we will spend the time

[01:14:32] to do that. But for now, if we can, and if it's acceptable to the superintendent, I'd like the board not to do sort of individual edits, but to let the process take place. And the individual edits will come in full public forum, you know, at the board meeting, you know, either during first review or during final review, hopefully in January. So I mean, as everybody else has, Christonia, I commend you and the team for the work you're doing.

[01:15:03] It's a difficult balance in a very public spotlight. And you're doing it for people who We've got, you know, honestly, I was going to say divergent views, but I don't even think that's right. I think that at the end of the day, the amount of material that you'll find disagreement on is less than a couple percentage points of the overall material in the document.

[01:15:22] I just don't believe that the views of history on this board, or frankly in the Commonwealth, are so different that we can't reach common ground in an amicable way. And, you know, I hope I'm proven right about that. You know, I've been wrong before, but I don't think I'm this one.

[01:15:39] I think we're moving down a good path, and, you know, I thank the superintendent for, you know, I know we took a pause that we didn't expect, right? We were rolling toward a specific goal. We took a pause. We're happy with the pause. I do think the resulting two-document format is better for us as a state than the combined, and it had nothing to do with what you guys did.

[01:16:04] I mean, I understand where that came from, but let's all move on. And, you know, be thankful that we have the ability to discuss this in this way. Dr. Mann, I thought I closed that. You did. You did, but I also think what my hope for is as we embark upon the process, you know, over the years, I've had the honor and privilege of serving on the board.

[01:16:30] I think I have been in awe of the level of expertise that gets brought to bear every time we embark upon doing this kind of work and it is my sincere hope that as we undertake this given the extensive work even the fact that we're having community engagement sessions that is not a part of what typically happens when standards are reviewed and adopted there are public hearings and through the public hearing process that input comes to us so when you when you contemplate the

[01:17:06] extent of input that's happened up to this point and what you all are committing to do by virtue of conducting public hearings and additional community engagement sessions. I think there is an overabundance of opportunity to really hear from people and make certain that as we're hearing from people, we're engaging with historical accuracy perspective to shape our thinking we would do that for math we would do that for reading we would do that for every other

[01:17:40] standard that we're responsible for revising and updating and it is my hope that that anchor point will guide us as we undertake what clearly is a very um charged area of work for us and i think we have to be able to honestly say that so that we can rightfully deal with the matter before us so i just thank you um and that's my hope as we take this on as a board so go forth and ignore us for

[01:18:18] a while and thanks i would love to in that case i'm i'm sorry but i i've got a pile on president thank you for closing and it was wonderful so consider this an addendum to the closure i i want to just thank the the videoe staff because there have been three really distinct pivots that you all have made um number one was before this process started um being asked to do something with these standards that you haven't been asked to do before number two was when a new

[01:18:53] administration came in and i asked you to take some different directions with the process work And number three was with the pause that brings us to today and the work that you've undergone. I absolutely think that it is the appropriate entry point for the members of this board to have conversations that have taken place so far.

[01:19:15] It's guided our work over the last three weeks since our last board meeting. Today, the discussion about crosswalk inquiry-based versus fact-based, looking at the sources that we're looking at and making sure that we're balanced with that. Those are all really, really appropriate and important conversations for this board to have and to continue to have.

[01:19:36] And one of my goals as the state superintendent and the secretary of this board is to make sure that this board has more opportunities in other subject areas to sort of get these check-in points along the way through either samples or actual drafts of the work to continue to get some of that high level and conceptual feedback contemplation that that I know I rely on this board for I also just want to say you know over the last couple of years we've we've got parents across across the United States who are more engaged than ever and who want to be part of the

[01:20:11] solution that said from the time that that I was in a teacher and in grad school what a standards document with the purpose of the standards document has really evolved. And I think that we all see the standards document now as much more of a public facing document that explains and is a tool for parents and the public to use to understand what the scope and sequence is of a particular content area in a school or in a state or in the nation. And so I think that it's really, really important this pause

[01:20:50] and this extra work that we're taking on the standards document is so vital because we do, as you said, Chris Danya, I'm a fan of saying ready for prime time. We want that to be ready for prime time so that we can engage parents in being part of the solution and that's the really appropriate entry point for this and we need your continued contemplation on that.

[01:21:12] I will also just, you know, with respect to the curriculum frameworks that are there, it feels really daunting when we say we're going from one big document to 14 little documents. And I don't, I just wanna make sure that we're clarifying that that's not just splitting the documents apart and having the same things that are in 496 pages or wherever we are right now into 14 smaller documents.

[01:21:39] And so Ms. Holton, while we will certainly keep you apprised of and Ms. Creasy through things like crosswalks and conversations, redlining, et cetera, the changes that are taking place.

[01:21:55] You know, some of those changes include things like redundancy and tightening our document. Ms. Duda, you talked about the profile of a graduate. Where possible, we wanna make sure that we tighten that to a point where we have links in there and maybe not the whole document that may be misperceived by the public as being part of the standards document and it's something that stands on its own.

[01:22:19] So those are conversations that this incredibly adept staff is having every single day that they're contemplating on, that they're making changes on. So some of those changes really are in an effort to make this a document that maybe the nation, certainly Virginia hasn't seen before in a standards and curriculum document in the sense that it serves so many purposes.

[01:22:44] It's a tool for parents and the public. It's a tool for teachers and administrators and curriculum directors in the school. And that's really our goal. And just to wrap it up, although President Gecker already closed, I'll just say, we want the best standards.

[01:23:00] And so your continued contemplation, Virginia's continued engagement as contributors and as voices in this is very important. And again, VDOE staff, that is tough water to navigate. And thank you very much.

[01:23:16] Thank you all. Dash for the door. Okay. Thank you. I think it's time we win the prize for the most slides.

[01:23:52] Ready?

[01:24:23] I'm ready. All right. Good afternoon, everyone. Today, Shelly and I will be presenting information regarding Virginia's accreditation model in preparation for any potential changes recommended by the committee that will convene to address house bill 938 during the board work session in august 2022 dr sale presented information on house bill 938 which requires the virginia board of education to collaborate with the superintendent of public instruction and the secretary of education to convene stakeholders to evaluate

[01:25:00] and make recommendations on certain goals regarding public education three of the goals relate to accountability a report is due to the chairman of the house and senate education committees on stakeholder findings and recommendations no later than november 30th 2022. since the house bill 938 committee work is getting ready to begin we thought it was appropriate to review the current accreditation model with all board members so that everyone has the background information necessary to engage with the recommendations that come forward we

[01:25:36] will also be requesting your initial feedback at the end of this presentation therefore as we are presenting we would like the board to think about the strengths of the current system ways in which the system can be improved and whether those improvements would require a long-term or a short-term change it's also important to think about ways to make the system more accessible to schools in the community for instance what long or short-term changes could take place to make data more readily available or what changes would perhaps simplify the overall process

[01:26:14] and make it more easily understood by schools and the community are there indicators that should be added or changed in order to strengthen the current system and finally in what ways can we make improvements to further differentiate performance so that year-to-year comparisons can be made to improve school quality i'm going to quickly review the three accountability goals in house bill 938. we will circle around to them again at the end of the presentation so that the board has an opportunity to provide input and during the first part of this presentation

[01:26:53] we'll provide some background information on the historical legislative and regulatory authority of the board then we will provide an overview of the accreditation system and then we will bring back the house bill 938 goals back in front of the board for any initial feedback that you would like to

provide the first accountability goal is actually goal three in the bill the goal is to increase the transparency of performance measures for public schools during the work session

[01:27:27] dr sale framed the task by providing questions to guide the discussion regarding transparency the questions relate to making complex information more under understandable to stakeholders as well as whether there is any additional information the department can provide that will promote transparency towards the end of the presentation we will take a quick look at the school quality profile information that we currently do provide on our website the second accountability goal is actually goal four in the bill its purpose is to ensure that performance measures for schools

[01:28:06] prioritize the attainment of grade level proficiency and growth during the course of the school year and from school year to school year in reading and mathematics for all students the questions which frame the task surround how both growth and proficiency should be included in the accreditation model specifically the questions ask how we might consider growth and proficiently a proficiency differently than we do now while both remain valued components of the accreditation system what can be done to ensure that each component is clearly represented and used

[01:28:45] appropriately in determining accreditation status the third goal which is goal six in the bill is to ensure that there is a strong accreditation system that promotes meaningful accountability year over year this goal is fairly broad with the general question of whether there are any changes to the accountability model that would promote meaningful and consistent accountability for example what changes might be made to minimize the complexity of the current model and simultaneously enhance clarity on whether schools are meeting multiple performance expectations as well does

[01:29:24] the current model differentiate a school's performance enough to give an accurate portrayal of strengths and weaknesses the second question on the screen pertains to whether triennial accreditation which is legislate legislated through the code of virginia should be removed this of course would necessitate a legislative change we will review triennial accreditation towards the end of the presentation and discuss that this question a little bit more in depth with those three goals stated there are four buckets that any proposed changes could fall

[01:30:03] into some of the changes could require change in legislation or regulation and that is uh the through the standards of quality or the standards of accreditation others will require board action only and do not need legislative or regulatory change some changes would only necessitate a change in business rules and others may only necessitate a change in how information is reported to stakeholders shelley is going to present some information on the legislative and

[01:30:39] regulatory authority of the board and provide a historical background on accreditation you can all right so since most of the discussion today does revolve around your own responsibilities regarding accreditation we wanted to make sure you had a bit of background on the legislative authority and also was included in the regulatory standards for accrediting schools so the next two slides really address um what is in the standards of quality that provides the board with the

[01:31:13] legislative authority to create regulations uh that would be accredited schools so essentially the soq says that you will promulgate regulations the administrative process act must be used which of course is a very lengthy process and then the soq also lays out some requirements and components that must be included those include student outcome and growth measures also includes requirements for instructional programs staffing requirements and several others so it's important

[01:31:49] for everyone to realize that the standards of accreditation really involve much more than just accrediting schools and you can see here that there is much more there than just the process that's used to provide a rate to schools this is the the second part of the reference and the soq and what i wanted to call your attention to here is really the last statement here there is a statement that the accreditation process for schools is must be transparent and based on objective measurements of course we've talked a lot about transparency already in the discussion

[01:32:29] questions around the goals of house bill 38 so this is uh just a description of the part of the standards of accreditation that deals with actual school accreditation it is part eight in the regulation and you can see that it has multiple sections we won't go over all of these today but as we move forward you probably will encounter many of them as we discuss with you potential changes over the next couple of months and since we just talked about history standards we thought

[01:33:07] it might be important to give you all a history of accreditation in virgin so before the late 1990s school accreditation was much more typical of what occurs across the rest of the country it was based on compliance with a set of requirements and then school visits and document reviews were used to evaluate that compliance in the mid to late 1990s as part of the reform effort where the standards of learning were revised and the sol tests were created there was a shift in the accreditation process for schools to more of an outcome-based model part of this was that

[01:33:45] school divisions wanted more flexibility in how they managed their schools so the shift really was to an outcome-based model where there were student expectations provided and then schools had more flexibility in how they met those expectations that's not to say that there aren't still lots of requirements within the soa that technically schools are supposed to meet before they are eligible to have an accreditation rating but there was a shift to focus more on student

[01:34:18] outcome measures the particular accreditation model that was put into place in the late 1990s focused primarily on sol test test pass rates english reading and writing mathematics science and history social science and the focus was really on all students there was not a focus on student groups additionally there was also emphasis on the graduation and completion index for schools that had a graduating class this system remained primarily unchanged until the

[01:34:56] revision in 2017 with two notable exceptions which we'll talk about next 2013 and 2014 the general assembly passed legislation that required the board to develop an a through f school grading system that system was developed but it was never implemented and it wasn't implemented because there was additional legislation that followed this that instead required the development of a school quality profile that school quality profile now known as the sqp replaced the

[01:35:33] old school report card and it really was intended to provide more transparent information to the public and amy is going to talk with you more about this sqp as we go through these slides i do want you to know that the same legislator who carried the the bill that required the development of the a-f grading system was also the patron of the bill that then required the school quality profile again the thought was that the school quality profile would provide more transparent

[01:36:06] information about specific indicators and then the last change before the 2017 change to the soa again through this legislation in the 2015 general assembly and here the requirement was that the board developed differentiated accreditation ratings the concern here was that in the old system the

ratings were accredited fully accredited accredited before morning or accreditation denied and the thought was that this did not provide enough differentiation to fully describe how

[01:36:46] schools were performing so you'll see that other ratings were added there's one that's partially accredited approaching the benchmark one of those for the pass rate and the gci this recognized schools that were not at the benchmark but were close the next addition was partially accredited improving school again for the pass rate and the gci these were schools that had made significant improvement but again had not met the benchmark and the amount of improvement that was required

[01:37:23] was differentiated based on how low the previous pass rates were so if the pass rates were very low then you know perhaps the requirement was that they improved by 11 points for a school to get this particular designation and then finally the warned category remained but it was differentiated between pass rate and GCI. So we did develop accreditation ratings for three years using this system. So 2015-16 through 2017-18. And so that brings us to the development of what the model

[01:38:01] that is currently in place, the 2017 accreditation model. The work on this actually began in 2015 and there were really multiple goals. One was to get at a better idea of how schools were really performing. There was concern that the previous differentiated model was too confusing and it really didn't give people a clear idea of where schools were. There was also a desire to correct some of what were seen as issues with the previous accreditation system. One of the most notable was

[01:38:37] that the previous system focused on all students there was no emphasis on student groups and as as you all know there is a concern that we address achievement gaps so that was one of the changes that was made and the other concern was that all of the indicators were academic based and so there was a desire to provide a more comprehensive picture by including additional indicators there was lots of discussion among the board members about which additional indicators should

[01:39:09] be added ultimately as you all know we added chronic absenteeism so the first accreditation ratings under the current model were released in 1819 we also released accreditation under this model in 1920 and then of course you know that we had accreditation waived in the next two years so this year of course we're releasing accreditation under this model and uh it's important to realize that we've really only accredited schools under this model for three years three times and i'm going to turn it back to amy now she's going to talk to you about the current model

[01:39:50] all right so in our current model there are nine school quality indicators there is academic achievement and that is reported out for mathematics english and science and that gets reported out for all students there is an achievement gap indicator for english and math which is where achievement is reported out for eight student groups so currently we have

[01:40:22] student groups for asian students black students hispanic white students of multiple races we have a student group for english learners students with disabilities and economically disadvantaged students we also have a chronic absenteeism indicator the graduation and completion index the dropout rate and the college career and civic readiness index the gci the dropout rate and the

[01:40:55] cccri are based on the graduation cohort so those indicators only apply to schools that have a grade The CCCRI is an indicator that will be active for the first time in 2023, 2024, and that will be based on this year's data.

[01:41:18] Each indicator is assigned a performance level, either a level one, which means the school is performing at or near the, I'm sorry, a level one, which means the school is performing at or above the standard.

[01:41:34] And when I say the standard, that is the benchmark for a particular indicator. A level two means the school is performing near the standard. And a level three is the indicator is performing below the level one and the level two benchmarks.

[01:41:56] The assigned performance levels determine an accreditation status. And the combination of those performance levels will determine whether a school is accredited or accredited with conditions.

[01:42:12] And I do want to mention that the achievement gap indicators, the chronic absenteeism, dropout rate, and the CCCRI were not part of that old system, as Shelly mentioned, but they were added when the 2017 model was created.

[01:42:28] So the way in which accreditation rating is assigned is fairly straightforward. If all of the indicators are a level one or a level two, the school is accredited. If at least one of the school quality indicators is a level three, the school is accredited with conditions. There is another accreditation rating called accreditation denied, and that is assigned to schools that fail

[01:43:00] to adopt or fully implement required corrective action plans to correct the level three indicators so i am going to talk about the performance levels a little bit to show you how these levels are determined so if you look at what's highlighted on the level one indicator on the screen you'll see that the in order to get a level one that means that the performance level meets or

[01:43:38] exceeds the state standard and it's by using the current or the cumulative three-year rate so whatever one is best would be used to determine the um the performance level and that is one way to earn a level one another way to earn a level one is if the current year rate is in the level two range and performance demonstrates adequate improvement from the previous year and you'll

[01:44:12] see in that second column where it has level one and then i've got some parentheses there are two pieces of information in there one says r10 and one says i2 and that's typically how it's designated when we let a school know that they have met the level one performance level by showing adequate improvement r10 is actually a reduction in a failure rate from the previous year when

[01:44:42] we're talking about achievement indicators r10 is a reduction in the chronic absenteeism a 10 reduction in chronic absenteeism when we're talking about chronic absenteeism the indicator that does not use r10 is the graduation and completion index because with that we want that to increase from year to year so adequate improvement would actually be an increase of two and a half percent so when you look at a level two you'll see the same

[01:45:22] setup you'll see that in order to earn a level two performance would have to be in a specific range and when we look at that performance we look at the current year rate or we look at the cumulative three year rate whichever one of those is best is the one that's used the other way to earn a level two is by showing that adequate improvement again and what this means is that that current year rate is actually in that level three range but the performance does demonstrate adequate improvement

[01:45:59] from the previous year and again you're either reducing a rate by 10 percent from the previous year or in the case of gci you're increasing that rate by two and a half percent and then a level three is if

the performance meets a specified range that's below the level one and level two range and again if we use the current or the three-year rate we would use the highest one but if it falls below those level one and level two ranges it is a level three and then there is

[01:46:36] another way to earn a level three and that's called the level three four-year rating what this rating indicates is that if there is a school that has been at a level two or a level three through four consecutive years in that um next year we we look at their rating and if they're still a level two or a level three they will get this rating that's called a level three four years and it just simply means they're going either between level twos or level threes or they just

[01:47:15] have those four years where they just haven't earned a level one so they get this particular rating in order to get out of this rating the school actually has to earn a level one performance level in that indicator in order to get out of this level three so even if the school continues to earn say a level two it will have this level three rating until it earns a level one all right

[01:47:46] so i want to talk about the achievement indicators um next and on um this screen you can see that i have two columns there is one column that is labeled uh english and i do want to note that the english indicator does include reading and writing assessments we administer administer writing assessments in grade five and uh once in high school there's an eoc reading writing test

[01:48:20] we the column to the far right is one that is both for mathematics and science they have the same descriptions and you will be able to look and see what constitutes a level one what constitutes a level two and what constitutes a level three so for english in order for a school to earn a level one their current or cumulative three-year rate has to be greater than or equal to 75 percent

[01:48:55] and again if you read through what is in that box it's set up just like i went through on the previous slides that school could also be in a level two range show adequate improvement and they would have a level one r10 designation the level two if a school's current or cumulative three-year rate is less than 75 but it's greater than 65 it falls in that level two range if you

[01:49:32] continue to read in that box you will see that in order to get a level 2 r10 the rate the performance rate a school would earn would have to be between 50 and 65 percent and if they fell within that range and made adequate improvement they could be a level two and a level three would be when the current or the cumulative three-year rate is less than or equal to 65 percent so you You can compare that to the math and science column.

[01:50:08] And again, you can see the only real differences between those two columns is what the level one benchmark is. So for mathematics and science, the level one benchmark is 70%. So in order to get a level one, the current or the cumulative three-year rate would have to be greater than or equal to 70%.

[01:50:30] And then you can look through and see for level two, it would be less than 70%, but greater than 65%. And then for a level three, it's less than or equal to 65%.

[01:50:46] - Just a quick question. The difference between 70 and 75, is it just a reflection of the challenge of getting there on the math and science or? - Yeah, Shelley, I don't know if you have any insight as to how those were set at the time.

[01:51:02] - Yes, the 75 was set some years ago really recognize the importance of reading and learning everything else so that's why it's so hot all right so um when you look at this and you see that the current or

the cumulative three-year rate

[01:51:32] is i want to talk about what those actual rates are so for the academic achievement indicators and the achievement gap indicator for mathematics when we're talking about the rate has to be for math 70 or more in order to be a level one the rate we're talking about for elementary and middle schools is the combined rate and what the combined rate is it's a rate that includes students

[01:52:10] with a passing score and then it also includes students who failed the test but showed growth so that is what's in the rate that's used for elementary and middle schools for math at the high school it is simply the the rate of students who pass the test it's a pass rate there is no growth at the high school for english and this is the academic english achievement in english and the achievement gap in english it's also a come on combined rate but it's a little bit

[01:52:47] different this combined rate includes students who pass the reading and or the writing test so if you had an eighth grade student who took reading and writing both of their scores would be in the rate it also includes students with a failing reading test but that student showed growth. And then it also includes ELS students who did not pass the test. They didn't show growth,

[01:53:20] but they did show growth on the WIDA access for ELS test. And the WIDA access for ELS test is administered in the late winter, early spring timeframe. And students, English learners take that test and we gauge their proficiency in english from year to year so if they do show progress on that test but they did fail the actual reading test and they did not show growth we would still

[01:53:53] give credit in that numerator for that english learner student now at the high school there also is a combined rate for english and it does include students who pass the reading and or the writing test there is no growth component to it for students who failed the sol test except for l students and there is the component in there for l students who didn't pass the reading test but

[01:54:24] did show uh progress on that weta access for l's test from the previous year the last row on that table is academic achievement in science and there is listed in both columns it's a pass rate now you'll see in the chart that i did say accreditation pass rate and that is simply because we have do have another pass rate in virginia and that is the annual pass rate that is what is was publicly released in august and it is what shelly and sarah will be presenting to you in the next

[01:55:04] presentation when they're talking about the um the results of last year's testing but the calculations between the annual pass rates and the accreditation pass rates do fit do vary a little bit by a certain degree so i wanted to just be clear on this chart for whoever is looking at it that this is the uh the pass rate we calculate for accreditation and not the one we calculate for that annual pass rate one example just to try to give a little bit of clarity

[01:55:39] is in regards to substitute tests so a substitute test is a board approved a board approved test that some high school students use in lieu of an sol test to verify a standard credit so that they can um towards graduation and so substitute tests are included in an accreditation pass rate but they are not included in an annual pass rate so that's just one of the differences between the two yes

[01:56:17] mr president um so in these achievement indicators are are school divisions getting any credit for the pass advance rates that they achieve no no additional credit passes it's not weighted thank you yeah oops so i do um here is just a pictorial representation of an english combined rate at the

[01:56:50] middle school just to show you how it all comes together for growth so in this particular example there are 10 students who took the test and six of them passed so those are the ones that are labeled in green and then four of them failed and those are the students in red out of those students who failed one of them did show growth on the test so that student would be considered in the combined rate and of those students who failed there was a student who an english learner student

[01:57:30] who did show progress on the WIDA access for ELS test between the previous year and the current year. So the pass rate from this particular example would be 6 out of 10, but the combined rate would actually be 8 out of 10.

[01:57:48] So that is just an example to kind of show you how that combined rate works. And then digging a little bit deeper into the test records or what records count when we're looking at that rate, we are using standards of learning tests are counted in the achievement rates.

[01:58:17] We do use VAP tests and we do use most substitute tests. The test records that go into accreditation year are test records from the previous summer. So there are, and of course students who take summer school and do take testing.

[01:58:38] Those students or those records do count in the accreditation year. The current fall administration is included as well as the current spring test administration. So those are the three test administrations that get combined when we're determining these rates.

[01:59:00] And then another piece to the accreditation rates that I wanna talk about in terms of tests are those that are marked as recovery. So in general, when a student fails a reading or a math SOL test and is then provided remediation, during the next testing cycle, the test record is marked as recovery.

[01:59:25] And that does indicate that the student failed previous year and indeed indeed did receive remediation so if that student passes the current year's assessment that record does count two times in the numerator and two times in the denominator and that is different from a passing test that is not marked recovery that would count one time in the numerator and one time in the denominator so just an example that is on that screen you have a student who failed the fourth grade reading sol test the student receives

[02:00:03] remediation by attending summer school in the fifth grade the student's test record is marked as recovery the student passes the fifth grade reading test so that test record is counted as two in the numerator and two in the denominator all right so i wanted to try to give you some sort of a visual to put all of that information together when you're looking at a combined rate so if you look at the row that's labeled current year you will see that there are four columns that are

[02:00:41] highlighted in green and those are the columns that go into the numerator of the rate so we have their passing records so 168 students took this particular test and passed out of those 168 students two of the tests that were marked recovery were actually students who passed so that recovery column is what tells you that so that's where that those extra students are getting

[02:01:19] added into the denominator that second time two of them that were marked recovery passed and those are the two students that are marked in that recovery column there were seven students who actually failed the test but demonstrated growth and then there were 13 students who failed the test did not show growth but did show growth on the access for else test so when i add up those

[02:01:54] numbers i get the numerator and then i divide it by the total tests which is that i guess it might be a look like looks like a pinkish column a reddish column that total tests i just want to let you know does also include that extra two that is the recovery test so that that recovery was added extra in the numerator and it was added to the denominator and so that's how we get our combined rate. You'll also notice on this example that I gave you that the current year rate was a

[02:02:33] 76.61 and the cumulative three-year rate was a 78.95. I just put an asterisk next to that level one on the cumulative three-year rate because if this, if we were assigned, when we were assigning a level or a performance level, we would be using the cumulative three-year rate because it's a higher rate than the current year rate where did you get the denominator from the 248 the denominator

[02:03:08] is actually includes all of those columns that are the numerator plus students who failed okay so how many totals the 248 was the total number of students total so in order to determine um well yeah that includes the failures i should say it includes the failures who did not show growth and did not make l progress because those are included in that numerator does that make sense yes thank

[02:03:44] you all right i also want to talk a little bit about the achievement gap indicator so you can see how this gets evaluated so in the achievement gap indicator all of those student groups get a rate and each of those groups therefore get a performance level and it's the combination of those student group ratings or performance level that determines the overall rating of the indicator

[02:04:22] so on this whoops on this screen you can see i've got three examples for you for school a school b in school c and you can see each of the student groups were assigned a level if every student group is a level one obviously the overall performance level for that student group would be a level one the tolerance is to allow one group to be a level two so if as in school a

[02:04:54] is demonstrated there they are all level one but there's just only one level two and no level threes then your your overall rating for that indicator would be a level one for school b you can see that there are two level twos uh indicated in that column that by itself is enough to make it a level two so once you have more than one level two your overall indicator would be a level two

[02:05:28] you'll also see that there is one level three there if you have um one level three you can still remain a level two so if everything was a level one and there was one level three overall you would be a level two so school b certainly is a level two because it has both of those criteria in it and then school c you'll see that there is more than one level three and when there is more than

[02:06:00] one level three the overall indicator is a level three all right so i am going to move off of yep yeah going back on the previous slide just from a how are the students broken down by economically disadvantaged is that an overlapping category from the others just or is it um a distinguishable

[02:06:32] category with some of the others yes they are overlapped so if you add up those columns it wouldn't necessarily come up with the cohort of the number of students all right so any other questions on the academic achievement indicators before we go on to chronic absenteeism maybe just one more going back again just when you kind of cut the threads through this to see um

[02:07:06] do act economically disadvantaged kind of correlate with two or three of these other groups i'm just wondering if they um if that one you know is a certain level - Will it almost automatically align with English learners or one of the other categories?

[02:07:31] - It could. It just depends on the individual student body, but it definitely could. - But that's the only one that's overlapping. All the others are first-- - No, they can all overlap. You can have students in the Hispanic group-- - Austro, Hispanic, and special needs.

[02:07:48] - It is also an English learner, yep. Or a black student who also has disabilities, et cetera. i had one question it's like i wasn't sure if i could ask a question at that time just for level this is when you were talking about performance levels level one level two level three yeah theoretically a school could move directly from a level three to level one right they could okay

[02:08:17] you just jump level okay thanks are there any other questions all right then i am going to talk a little bit about chronic absenteeism. And the chronic absenteeism is an indicator that is the same for elementary, middle, and high schools. And it does represent the percent of students who are absent 10% or more of the days in which they're enrolled in school. Unexcused and excused

[02:08:54] absences are both counted in the rate. And there's a kind of a two-part process here. So the first thing is to determine a student's absenteeism rate. So you look at the individual student and you see how many days they were absent in a given school year. And that would go in the numerator for that student's absenteeism rate. And then you look at the denominator, which is the total number of days that student is in membership in a given school year. So for instance, if you had a school

[02:09:32] that was open 180 days and the school was the student was part of the was enrolled in the school from day one their membership days would be 180 if you have a student who transferred into the school later in the year their membership days would be differently so it just depends on the students when the student was enrolled so you take the number of days the student was absent divide it by the number of days that that student was in membership and you get that student's

[02:10:06] absenteeism rate they are counted in the chronic absenteeism rate if they were absent 10 or more of the time so when we calculate the chronic absenteeism rate the numerator is that number of students whose absenteeism rate was greater than or equal to 10 percent and then the denominator is all students whose end of year membership is greater than or equal to 50 percent so what that

[02:10:41] is saying is we're looking at all of the students that are in the school but if a student perhaps is a transfer student and comes in at the end of the year that student isn't included in the rate because they just haven't been in membership greater than or equal to 50 of the time so that is how the two rates are calculated and again when we're looking at chronic absenteeism and we're looking at a level one a school would be a level one if their current or cumulative three-year rate

[02:11:17] is 15 or lower and i know a lot of people get confused because we initially are talking about tagging somebody when they're absent 10 or more of the time and then when we talk about the level sometimes it does get a little bit confusing but again when we're looking at the chronic absenteeism rate we're identifying those students who are chronically absent and then we're when we're looking at the level we're saying we want 15 percent or lower of the students in a particular

[02:11:51] school to be chronically absent and that would make you a level one the range for a level two is if it's greater than 15 but less than or equal to 25 and then a level three is when the rate is more than 25 so those were the benchmarks all right are there any questions on chronic absenteeism all right i'm going to go on now these three indicators are indicators for schools that have

[02:12:29] a grade 12 it is the graduation and completion index the dropout rate and the college career and civic readiness index and the gci it's it's a weighted value based on student outcomes at the end of high school and the group that's evaluated is the on-time graduation cohort plus any carryover students and it does say adjusted on-time graduation cohort because as students enter

[02:13:06] high school they are assigned a cohort well as this cohort travels through high school you have students who transfer in you have students who transfer out you have students who are incarcerated you um you know may have students who are deceased so that on-time graduation cohort is adjusted and again those are students who were first-time ninth graders four years ago the carryover students

[02:13:37] are students who were members of a previous cohort they did not earn their diploma and they remained in school after their on-time graduation cohort to complete high school to either earn a diploma a ged or a certificate of completion so those are the students that are in that denominator the dropout rate is a rate that tells us the number or the percent of students who are either

[02:14:13] labeled as a dropout or an unconfirmed and that's their status um at the the end of the year as we they're labeled as a dropout or they're labeled as unconfirmed so the dropout rate is the number of students identified over the number of students in the on-time graduation cohort a dropout is any student who basically discontinues schooling they do not earn a diploma a ged or certificate of completion they aren't enrolled in any other public school or

[02:14:52] private school they're not out due to suspension they just simply stopped coming to school that is a dropout an unconfirmed student is a student whose records were properly reported to the state but we really don't know this their status it's inconclusive the the state doesn't have any record of the student earning any sort of diploma or certificate they don't have them located in

[02:15:25] another school even though a school is reporting that so i'll give you an example so school a has a student and reports that that student is supposed to transfer to school b and school b so school a reported correctly they were going to go to school b but school b doesn't report that they received that student and a lot of times that's because perhaps the the state testing

[02:15:58] identifier number that goes with the student perhaps a new one gets assigned so maybe that student really is at school b but he's got a different number so the state really doesn't know did that student at that point did that student transfer to school b or you know what happened to them so those are situations where a student may be in an unconfirmed status either

[02:16:24] way dropouts or unconfirmed are included in this in this rate yes we do want to we do want to wrap it up and and I know because I've had individual conversations with board members that we want to have um a little bit of time for discussion and questions also okay um you know and you know what and the slide presentation is so thorough that um there's a lot of it that can stand on its own okay

[02:16:58] and i know a lot of questions have been generated from that i will zip through the example but that just shows how um the outcomes the different outcomes are weighted to get the rate and here are the uh performance levels that go with the gci and the dropout rate and i'll just move right on to the college career and civic readiness index which most of you are aware of since we did talk

[02:17:32] about this at a previous board meeting and it is where there is credit given for student outcomes the outcomes are listed on the screen and so once a student meets one of those outcomes they

are in the numerator and then the on tom graduation cohort is in the denominator so meeting any of those outcomes would satisfy the criteria of a student meeting the cccri and then these are

[02:18:06] the descriptions that go along with the cccri and you will notice that there is just a current rate listed and that is because again 23 24 is the first year that cccri is going to be administered or used in accreditation all right i'm going to go very quickly through the school quality profiles just so you're aware of the information that is there there is a link if you wanted to go and and look at those school quality profiles but there is a series of tabs

[02:18:41] that are across the top and each of the tabs house different information there is an accreditation tab and an assessment tab that i'll talk about very quickly this accreditation tab does provide the accreditation status of a school it shows the indicator levels for a school and it also shows the indicator levels for the student groups as well as the actual rates that go with those levels

[02:19:18] and there are a series of buttons that i've got outlined in that red box that you can change the graphs if you wanted to look at a particular student group or a particular subject area so the rates and the performance levels are available and importantly there's also a table that desegregates the rate into its components so where i showed you that slide with the different columns those columns that were highlighted in green there is also information on the school

[02:19:52] quality profile that shows you the percent of students that are in each category in addition there's information on chronic absenteeism and there is historical information at well as well and for dropout rates and for the graduation and completion index and again this is a it does give you historical information i also just really briefly want to just touch on this assessment tab

[02:20:26] and this is the um the information that shelly and sarah will be presenting but this has the annual pass rates on it it does not have accreditation rates it has the annual pass rates on this particular tab and again there are bar graphs that you can display the pass rate information this particular slide is not on the school quality profile but i did want to give you just a snapshot of all of the different reports that are available for school divisions and there are

[02:21:05] a lot of reports that gives very specific detailed information on the accreditation reports how individual students are counted in the rates so there are just very many reports that schools have access to that does show them just a lot of the information and a lot of details that go into calculating accreditation this is an accreditation detail report that school divisions have access to that again this is just an example of how achievement gap looks when it is reported

[02:21:43] out to schools so that they can see the performance of each of the groups and again this just shows the detail that's in the report for some of the other indicators that was quick all right so shelley you want to get into the board discussion i will wait for direction from you all because i know you do need to get out of here yep it looks like we already have some questions generated and if we have a lull let's ask some of the discussion questions that that you formulated

[02:22:15] right um so i think the first first discussion question is really around transparency it really has two i'm sorry maybe yeah i think we have some questions yeah it's okay a great presentation it's so much content and there's so much more we can talk about about the changes to the accreditation system one thing i didn't see you do and i'm not suggesting we do it now but talk about what the consequences for schools are when they are not level one when you're yellow

[02:22:54] or red what that means in terms of improvement plans required for the schools and what that means in terms of intervention um and engagement with the state uh state staff but am i right that in without going into all the details of that gaps on reading and math are elevated at a higher level than in anything else in other words if you have gaps on your reading and math scores you're required to do more improvement plans and interventions than you are more generally

[02:23:29] well i was for if they're a level three is a your so you're indicating if they're a level three versus a level two are you required to do more is that your question no it's for math and reading highlighted have so even schools that are level two and reading and math have to undergo an academic review and have a corrective action plan so basically anybody who's level two or level three has to have some kind of action plan but you have more if you're in level three and you have more if your gaps are the differentiation is it's all students if it's all students not meeting the

[02:24:03] benchmark are at level two so we're not looking at subgroups but right we can have um we can get that's a longer discussion it is a very long discussion consequences for anything that's not green but there are more consequences if it's reading and math i think a broad brush characterization if i may anybody else um so this is regarding house bill 930 it's a goals uh i think you're

[02:24:39] talking about two of four goal four and um the discussions about growth proficiency and the methodologies. It can sound very academic, you know, it's great, but for parents out there, you know, they don't think their children's education is rigorous or challenging, and they're supplementing their children's education out of school and math and reading, as you may know, many, at least in Northern Virginia, many people are supplementing their kids' children's education. How can we bring supplementary as just like a nuts and bolts of how can we,

[02:25:18] addition to some of the discussions great presentation by the way and great slides how can we bring the supplementary education in the school just some ideas to throw out there you know as an option and it's just as an option and i'm sure people parents would love to take advantage of that it's you know it doesn't have to be teaching resource extensive it can be something like what places like kuman do you know just give extra daily 15 to 20 minute of homework or just a work incremental reiterative and then it wouldn't really require teaching but the end the

[02:25:56] homework can be graded at home it just or it could be public private partnership it's just something to perform you know increase the performance of children performance measures for a school also i think it's a good idea to let to allow for more tracking allow more students to accelerate those who can take the iowa tests earlier and have shown an ability to be able to to accelerate one other example i'll just give you one example and happen in fairfax county actually in

[02:26:35] is the justice high school used to be known as tour when the first virginia state standards of learning were given in the late 1990s tours or justices mass passing rate was the lowest in the county and then the math teacher there was a math teacher stu sing singer and um the principal riddled he challenged them and what they did was it's a great initiative they did a algebra one part one so students doing poorly after first semester algebra one transfer to algebra one part one first

[02:27:12] spring semester solidifying their understanding and the next year they took algebra one part two and then by 2005 singer said that stewart had the highest passing rate in the county on sol algebra one besting school that had almost no low-income students and you know having built that foundation algebra

one the math teachers created double block algebra two what that double block algebra two did was that you know students who still had problems math took two full periods of algebra two

[02:27:46] giving them more time to work on basics so in the second year of the program 90 percent of students in the double block classes passed the sol algebra 2 higher than the county's average rate um unfortunately in april 2008 this was uh um you know it was taken out but and this was also reported in the washington post but these are just some great initiatives that just can really really bolster when we talk about you know these could be you know ideas that when you implement

[02:28:32] this is wonderful i think i might maybe be as smart as a fifth grader on this now so thank you um no promises um just in terms of the covet effect and um and the three-year accreditation process and that it's staggered i i take it i'm just wondering just even from a real life as we're looking into recommendations on are there things that the last two years have maybe brought into place yeah so over the last the last two years when accreditation has been waived so

[02:29:06] when we're looking at like a cumulative three-year rate we were actually looking at 21 22 a year and then we skipped those two years and used the two years prior i'm just assuming though that within that even though the process was waived that when we kind of come out of the shoot there's going to be and i think you'll see the the um the rates when shelley goes over them what's transpired basically for the three-year rate this year it's 17 18 18 19 and 21 22. so two pre-rendemic in one

[02:29:43] post okay yeah and just with that um even with the 21 22 drop off have you noticed or just what's the data showing on more schools being in tier two or tier three or um in terms of the preliminary preliminary um that is actually getting ready to be released next week okay i won't get ahead of you maybe i'll take a hit for that without um without divulging or releasing information that i don't

[02:30:17] know yet because it's not finalized but what i what i can say is that there's no accreditation system or state accountability system in the nation that was set up to withstand what we've experienced as a nation and as a state and um you know so with without getting too data e um this an accreditation system is is really a little bit of a lagging indicator in terms of of improvement so while traditionally historically we've used it as sort of an impetus for improvement

[02:30:53] when it does not create the sense of urgency that we need it to create right now. And I'll leave it at that so I don't get in trouble with Shelly and Amy. - No, I'll let you get in trouble. I'm not gonna get in trouble.

[02:31:09] I don't think you can get in trouble. - Sorry, this is great, by the way. This is really helpful. - Thank you. - A ton of information. On this particular point, since I've got to be really careful to make sure we communicate to people that these are accreditation ratings that are being based on data that in some cases, It sounds like it's going to be four, maybe five years old.

[02:31:29] And like, that's a big deal, particularly if you think about like an elementary school. So in terms of this point on urgency, because there's a lot of stuff out there and people hear about the NAEP and then they hear something else from us and just make sure we're communicating pretty clearly. I mean, in my view, what is the gravity of the situation with what we're seeing?

[02:31:48] On this, can you talk, I have a couple of questions. One, how does this impact divisions? We're talking a lot about schools. Like, how are we thinking about accountability and accreditation for divisions themselves? - So accreditation is at the school level. So a county does not get a rating.

[02:32:06] It just, it is at the school level. - Is that something we should be thinking about? - It could be something we could be thinking about. - There is a different process in place if a school division does have a large number of schools that are not accredited. There is a process where we can go in and do what's called the division level review.

[02:32:25] then based on that that whole division may be under an mou or a memorandum of understanding with this board so we do have a number of school divisions who are have that mou with our office of school quality currently okay so that actually one thing i think would be super helpful that i'm confused about i may be the only one and if i am i apologize for asking you to do work just for me but if you could give us all these memorandum understand i know petersburg has been under one for a long time i think there's one in one in richmond there's some others if you could give us just like for each of them just like how long they've been in place with the cons what has happened with um the changes i think that'd be because it i'm i i may be the only one but i'm

[02:33:04] confused about the extent of those um uh i do agree with my colleagues i think this is too complicated i mean like i'm struggling through it it's just i don't know how like we have to find some way just to signal to parents not just in terms of like red green yellow but like measures that are simpler um rather than like what's behind them i mean it's great rigorous work but man it is confusing and i think that's that people have to be able to sort of intuitively you know like you look at consumer reports you can kind of pretty quickly understand the inputs for why the you know car or the washing machine got the rating i think we have the same we've got we've got to figure out

[02:33:40] a way that's both rigorous you know and works um but also uh is simple so it's more of an editorial comment my third like could we also get an analysis because like it's a three-legged stool and we're talking you know we talked about standards earlier this afternoon now we're talking about accreditation and accountability um and there's this third piece which is the tests and the cut scores and what does it actually mean to be passing proficient or passing advanced could we get an analysis on that like ideally going back as far as you can just to help understand sort of at what points were those changed why um uh how they're set where

[02:34:18] we are because i think that's like that's a key part of this and because like you know the the accreditation system does not operate independently of that and if the cut scores are super rigorous and the accountability system may not need to be so rigorous and vice versa if the cut scores aren't then you got to put more pressure on the and and i i am just there's been so many changes uh i'm a little confused about that i think just getting that like from you guys just straight up uh laying out what's happening would be and i mean i know you have that in your head so if you could get it down on paper that'd be fantastic if i may mr gecko i think one complication of the current system is not all the indicators are based on the tests so there's more of a disconnect

[02:34:57] between the test and the cut cut scores than there was in the past when it was mostly tests and graduation rates but yes we can certainly get you historical information about when the tests changed grace um so i have a couple of comments um you know as we start to think about what kind of improvements and how transparent we can be in getting really everyone to be understanding from parents to teachers to school principals to um you know central office staff and

[02:35:34] superintendents. And so I think a lot of what I'm seeing is we are asking our schools to be proficient when we really want them to show, to be exemplary, right? And so how do we better build an

exemplary model and do so giving schools credit for exemplary performance? For example, My question earlier about, are we not giving schools credit for pass advance rates on the SOL?

[02:36:13] That, to me, is a huge indicator of student outcomes. I mean, I remember when I was in the classroom, it wasn't satisfactory for me as a teacher to simply have my students pass. I wanted my teaching and my ability to be reflected in my kids being the best that they could be, is achieving the most that they could achieve um the the the other thing that i was thinking about as you were going through the presentation is that we in the classroom do a lot of our

[02:36:49] scope and sequence and our curriculum refining as schools in both vertical and horizontal alignment methods. And so in that regard, I think it would be extremely helpful to schools if we look at the year to year and current trends in that sort of direction, if you know what I mean.

[02:37:17] So taking year to year, but helping schools to improve through that current year to improve year over year. Does that jive with, do you understand where I'm going with that? step go on a progression and at the same time step up so for example with the new through year growth assessments for reading and math to look at progression or growth within the year but then

[02:37:48] also year to year is that what you're saying is crazy absolutely one other question i had was how are we defining adequate improvement so the adequate improvement is um for most of the indicators it's a reduction in a rate so for achievement it's a reduction in a failure rate for chronic absenteeism it's the reduction of the chronic absenteeism rate by at least 10 percent

[02:38:25] gci is the the only one that has a different litmus and that is increasing the rate by two and a half percent because we want gci to go up and not down so it's 10 or more on everything except gci seabird uh first of all thank you thank you and thank you for the history because i i think we are as a profession as a nation as a state on an accountability journey on an accreditation

[02:39:03] journey so seeing where we were and where we are is very important um i think you know superintendent bailo's points were excellent you know the whole red yellow green was intended to be easy to understand um but it wasn't built for a pandemic and also the three-year triennial that was intended for a high-performing school to be able to innovate because they could try some stuff and they weren't going to take it on the chin because they tried something in a given year again that wasn't built for a pandemic so i think you know from this this journey perspective we have to simultaneously be thinking long term as a board i think it's going to take a chunk of time of where we want assessment accountability to go but we also have this near-term need of where we are

[02:39:41] and and and people are really in school schools are struggling so this is this long-term overhaul and then also we got to really kind of show the sense of urgency that the sergeant baylor pointed out about about where we are red yellow green is very interesting people get traffic lights but it doesn't aggregate well you can't really average the colors and roll them up into an indicator so you know back to the your history about the 8f you know the the legislator involved there you know he decided that you know he didn't want his own children being reduced to a one grade because his children were multiple factors and so a school full of many children shouldn't be one grade but then you know but how do we aggregate you know so we think about the things we go to

[02:40:18] what we do gpas maybe maybe other states have cracked this a little bit maybe ccsso has some ideas but um i think that the some sort of a clarity the school of quality profile is as rich as we ever wanted

it to be but there you know how do we aggregate something up to a meaningful meaningful level remains a bit of a challenge and again it's it's a i think we have a short term how do we report out where we are right now and and so we have a sense of urgency but also be thinking about long term how do we want to our steps to move us toward a desired goal on this

[02:40:53] but i think that's why it was really really helpful uh to have the history and um but going and manners our work cut out. Along those lines, Alan, you also need to be mindful of, well, I mean, you need to decide what the purpose is. If the purpose is to be easy for parents to pick schools, then you're going to move towards simple. If the purpose is to provide the systemic incentive for the local divisions to improve schools, you're going to have a different looking system. If the purpose is to reduce gaps in the schools, I mean, for example, you know, when we first did

[02:41:32] the pure academic accountability system. Schools would, frankly, routinely ignore the bottom 30% or the bottom 25%, right? Because they were never going to, well, except those on the bubble. Who did you have to pay attention to?

[02:41:48] The kids on the bubble. Because in order, superintendents, with all due respect, want to be accredited, right? I mean, that's one of the goals. That's how they get rated performance-wise. And so, and I've had enough conversations with enough superintendents to believe they played the rules. But the kids in the bottom 25% suffered for that.

[02:42:06] And so, you know, I talked to, you know, Kirk Schrader, who was, you know, part of the whole SOL and an old friend of mine, you know, when I first took over as president of the board. And, you know, Kirk said the theory was good. In practice, however, you know, the theory was we're going to identify those places which aren't doing well, and then we're going to allocate resources to fix those places.

[02:42:30] Well, we identified those places which aren't doing well, but we really haven't done a good job allocating resources and providing the incentives to fix those places. And all we've seen happen by, you know, the pure academic system is a further divide among our schools in terms of socioeconomic divide as parents move to school, you know, the best school they could afford that had the highest ratings.

[02:42:55] I mean, if we want simple ratings, all we need to do is go to greatschools.com, and I'll give you a single number that every realtor uses and, frankly, drives home values in every neighborhood in the Commonwealth, and, frankly, probably the country. But I don't know that. I certainly know it here. So what we were looking to do, and I'm not saying we got it entirely right, but the philosophy of where we were was, you know, there's plenty of data out there if people want to seek it.

[02:43:21] We wanted to provide people in your former position with an incentive. And I can remember being, I won't even name the jurisdiction, but it's in the Tidewater area. And the superintendent said, we can't possibly be responsible for getting kids to school, right? The absentee indicator.

[02:43:37] And they just didn't want the obligation. But frankly, when we imposed that obligation, because kids aren't gonna learn if they're not in school, and frankly, 18 days, 10% is a lot of days to miss, right? And to have 10% of your school basically miss 18 days is a huge thing. How did that happen?

[02:43:53] It's because they didn't factor into the old system, right? they were below that 70% or 75% level. Nobody cared. Now, all of a sudden, they care. And, you know, the pandemic is clearly problematic in terms of knowing whether what we did worked, right? Who knows? We're not going to know for another

couple of years. But the point is, we provided the incentive for superintendents to say, I'm going to get these kids in school.

[02:44:19] And frankly, I mean, it's not a hard lift. I, you know, I did the tour of Southwest Virginia, they had very innovative ways to bring kids in, very inexpensive and innovative ways. I guess to Andy's point, which is one I think the board ought to more seriously study, and I'm not going to co-opt your point, and I hope I get it close. There ought to be, because so much of what drives performance really comes from the superintendent level down.

[02:44:50] We rate individual schools, but there ought to be some division-wide measures we use to say, say, are you folks doing this well for all the students in your jurisdiction? Are you fairly allocating resources? Are you paying attention to not just that top 70, but also the bottom 30 in a way that's meaningful to advance every student in the commonwealth, not just those who happen to fall above that magic line we created 22 or whatever it was years ago.

[02:45:22] I mean, the work, in my mind, what we did wrong as a board, and the old board members have heard this before, is, and I don't mean this board per se, but as a board of education, we put together a system that had a pretty good logic model to it, right?

[02:45:37] You set thresholds, and people will move to those thresholds. What we didn't do, though, is two years, three years, four years, five years into the implementation of that system, go back and say, is this doing all we want it to do? Are there things it's doing that we don't like?

[02:45:54] And what changes can we make to mitigate the downside and, you know, maximize the upside? Because like I said, the academic model is a good model. It just hasn't really worked to do. The same people who were in trouble 22 years ago are basically in trouble today, right?

[02:46:10] I mean, it's no secret. It's, you know, poor divisions, you know, or divisions who have, you know, higher percentages of lower socioeconomic students. That's where it is. And we can talk about accreditation, you know, from now until all of our terms are over, not just mine.

[02:46:28] But until, you know, you sort of decide as a threshold matter, is it parent information I want to give out? Do I want to improve performance of the upper students? Because, I mean, frankly, the academic, raising academic bars clearly improves performance of the upper students.

[02:46:45] Or do I want to reduce gaps? That is, do I want to, you know, move the lower performers up to a level that's acceptable? You know, I'm not going to decide that policy. The board ought to decide that policy. But, you know, in terms of thinking about how we go about this, there is no quick fix to where we are, right?

[02:47:05] There just isn't. And frankly, you know, you can take all the conversations and you can put different, you can see where different people's priorities are. None of them are wrong, right? But sooner or later, the board has got to meld into a system that says, these are the real priorities.

[02:47:23] and this is what we're looking to accomplish, and these are the levers we can push to accomplish it. We can't get into a classroom. We can't tell a teacher what to teach. We can, however, skew the incentives to provide better building leadership, right? We can, there's a lot we can operate on at the division level, and from my perspective, and I think this is, you know, part of what Andy was getting to ask about, about division-wide indicators.

[02:47:49] You know, we ought to be thinking about what can we do at the division level to implement or to facilitate, to incentivize those things that we think ought to be outcomes for all of our kids. Sorry, long talk. And I know it's getting near dinner time.

[02:48:05] Everybody's angry. The superintendent tells me she's gonna go in the woods and shoot us some deer and feed us all tonight. So. - And I'll try to be brief. I just think that a couple of thoughts.

[02:48:21] One is one of the things, and the system is by no means perfect. No doubt about that. fact that it's too complicated is uh obvious um but there were a lot of there was a lot of thought that went into it over a matter of literally five or six years a lot of input from the public and we're really we're really still in the very beginning of its implementation and so i would just encourage folks to think that through before making changes president gecker led us through a process over the last couple of years to hear input from the public to see if there were

[02:49:00] small changes that we should make or immediate changes that we should make. And, you know, essentially we came up to the conclusion that, no, there weren't big changes we should make or even really that there was a lot of tinkering we should do right away. So I would just encourage us to think long term about how to get it right, but let's have at least a few years of experience with it one of the one of the major priorities was to focus more on college and career readiness and we don't even have the first year of indicators on on that the one other thing i wanted to point out is one of the major weaknesses of the prior system that we were focused on was

[02:49:39] it was just so punitive especially on teachers who were willing to teach poor kids it basically told teachers who were willing to teach poor kids that they were failures and it had the not unsurprising consequence of forcing any teacher who could possibly to get the heck out of dodge teacher exits from high poverty schools uh were through the roof and they would tell you left and right it was because oh you know you would go into visit these schools well i know we're accreditation denied but we're trying and et cetera et cetera and it was not a system that focused on continuous

[02:50:17] quality improvement so we one of our major goals was to shift to a system of that would not have that would not punish those who were teaching our our neediest kids and that would in fact help identify those most troubled schools and set up a system where the state could effectively collaborate and provide oversight and support and and hold them to high standards and help them improve, but for instance, I mean, one of the things we looked at is if you have a system

[02:50:49] that basically results in your entire, you know, 1,000 out of our 1,400, if it declares 1,000 schools failures out of our 1,400, unless there's a major, major shift in our budget, our State Department of Education cannot effectively intervene with 1,000 schools.

[02:51:09] But if we can get them down to a manageable number of really focusing on the schools and kids that really most need state intervention then we can intervene effectively and that was one of the goals was to have it be have it be manageable i think that's right but i think the challenge is like we can't have a system that labels a thousand schools as failures a thousand schools in the state aren't failures that wouldn't like doesn't have face validity but if we it depends i mean i totally agree with you like we have we have to it's like it's like the software business so like you can have it you know fast good or cheap but you can only have like two of those you know we're gonna have to make trade-offs we can't have everything we want but if we come from

[02:51:48] a point of view if we come at this one point we say what we we care about uh one of the things we care about is equity and making sure that we don't have these gaps that we see any system is going to cause a lot of heartburn in some communities that want to say and this is i think exactly what our president was saying a minute ago want to say our schools are great but then you get in there and you're like well except you know 25 of your kids who are disproportionately african-american kids or hispanic kids or poor kids or all those things are not doing well in the old system my critique of is it didn't take any of that into account with this so you'd have schools that could hit that 70 bar but in that building there was a lot of stuff going on that i think was not

[02:52:27] where we wanted to go so i think we're going to have to figure out like you're right we can't we can't just label schools it should not be punitive but i don't think we should start from the point of view of like what's the right number i think we should start from the point of view of like what are the right values that we want to see reflected in the system and then figure out and some of that may be a messaging challenge and how we you know how we how we talk about it and so forth and some of that may be substantively up to figure out because we can't just like shock the system but i'd urge us just to start thinking what are the things that are important helping advanced students addressing stem and so forth keeping virginia competitive addressing these

[02:53:04] achievement gaps in equity you know what other you know resources and finance i think is obviously an important one figure out like how do we want to do that and then i think like the other piece will fall will will fall into place i think we'll be in a better position to have those conversations if people are like wow that is not quite what i thought was going on um we will be better set up for starting place of values to to what you just mentioned i just have one one final point and it's the the national center for education statistics publishes data for um this is just one of the things that occur to me minimum number of instructional days and hours in the school years

[02:53:41] and the minimum number of hours per school day per state so if you look at the 2020 data virginia ranks near the near 10th from the bottom in terms of instructional hours if you increase just 30 minutes per day of instruction time so it would rank near the eighth from the top so 30 minutes extra per day would be like 90 extra instruction hours imagine 90 extra hours of math or reading

[02:54:09] you know just little pieces that could benefit and help schools increase performance all right uh i think i've got emily over there looking at me it's uh seven minutes from dinner i wish I wish you'd have told me that you had dinner plans.

[02:54:34] I would have gone faster from the beginning. - No, we're all good, all good. - Such good information. - As Gillian said, the slides stand pretty well alone in this and in the next presentation, which is also not going to occur, and thank you all very much for putting it together.

[02:54:49] This will be a topic that comes up a lot, I think. You know, it's gonna be a clear focus of where we're going, you know, as we look to improve the system overall. I mean, certainly the accreditation piece is one of those levers we have to drive improvement at the school level and hopefully at the division level.

[02:55:08] But I think Andy's right. We gotta decide on what the values are and then move forward from there. And part of it's about transparency, but a lot of it to me really is about how do we get people to do what we want them to do to get the outcomes we want.

[02:55:23] So with that, unless there's anything else, we can have it whenever you'd like it. We can do it now if you really want. but I think Jillian will kick me again. No, exactly.

[02:55:39] I'm happy to reschedule it.

[02:55:49] I'd welcome that. And some of the questions that Shelley had teed up, I think, are great. I don't know what our agenda looks like for next month, but having an opportunity to have that, I think, would be great. With the strong, I move that it's not right now.

[02:56:05] Is there a second? - There you go. All right, we are adjourned until dinner.

